

Q Do you have any plans to leverage your leadership at the Linux Foundation to enable greater participation of women in the growth of open source?

Yes, this is one of my key focus areas at the Linux Foundation—to advise, advocate and support programming around welcoming more women and minorities into open source.

Q How is the Linux Foundation making open source developments easy for developers and solutions providers?

The Linux Foundation's biggest impact is to create training, events and education around how to work with open source for developers and companies. It also houses and funds critical projects in the industry and provides tools, best practices and education around open source compliance. All of this makes it easier for developers to create projects that are valuable.

Q What are the advantages of joining the Linux Foundation for companies like Western Digital?

The Linux Foundation has become a central place for collaborative development in the industry, and companies that do work with open source have

benefited by becoming members. This non-profit organisation helps companies like Western Digital become strategic and skilled at consuming, contributing, collaborating and becoming compliant in open source. This is a key external engagement that all companies need to learn to manage as they become disrupted by digitisation and open source.

Q On a concluding note, how do you see open source evolving in the next five years?

As more industries and products are touched by open source, we will see a lot of new people and industries enter the community. We need to make it welcoming and easy to get involved.

There will be a need for collaboration across open source projects, so that individual projects do not work as islands.

Open source tools will become easier to use and will be taught in schools. Best practices and consistent practice of how to manage open source development will reduce fears and uncertainty about open source across the industry. Moreover, open source methods inside companies will be increasingly used as the way forward to develop software. 

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